



PROVIDENCE ENGLISH PRIVATE SCHOOL

Global Citizenship Policy

2026 – 2027

Approved for FS 2 – Year 13

POLICY REVIEWED BY

Senior Leadership Team & Subject Coordinators

POLICY REVIEWED DATE

August 2026

POLICY APPROVED BY

School Principal

NEXT REVIEW DATE

September 2027

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1 Aims & Objectives

Providence English Private School (PEPS) is committed to nurturing internationally minded, socially responsible young people who understand their role as citizens of both the United Arab Emirates and the wider world. Rooted in the UAE's values of tolerance, coexistence and openness, our approach to Global Citizenship prepares students to engage thoughtfully with local and global communities.

Our aims are:

- To develop students' understanding of, and pride in, Emirati culture, heritage and values, alongside an appreciation of the diversity of the school's multicultural community;
- To foster respect, empathy and tolerance towards people of all nationalities, cultures, religions and backgrounds;

- To develop students' awareness of global issues, including sustainability, human rights and social justice, and their connection to local action;
- To encourage active participation in community service and charitable initiatives, locally and globally;
- To build the skills of critical thinking, collaboration and communication needed to contribute meaningfully to an interconnected world;
- To align school practice with the UAE's national vision for tolerance, sustainability and global engagement;
- To meet the standards for global citizenship and intercultural learning set out by the Council of International Schools (CIS), in line with PEPS's commitment to CIS International Accreditation.

2 Legal, Regulatory & Strategic Framework

This policy is written to align with the following UAE national frameworks and priorities, and with the standards of the Council of International Schools (CIS), of which PEPS is a member:

- **UAE National Education Charter:** the Charter's pillars on national identity, global competitiveness and future-ready citizenship;
- **Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA):** standards for moral education, social responsibility and community engagement in private schools;
- **UAE Moral Education Programme:** the Ministry's framework covering character and morality, individual and community, civic studies, and cultural studies, which this policy's values-based approach reflects;
- **UAE Vision 2071 and the UAE Centennial Plan:** the nation's long-term vision for education, tolerance and global leadership;
- **National Strategy for Wellbeing and the UAE's designation of tolerance as a core national value** (including the Ministry of Tolerance and Coexistence's guiding principles);
- **Council of International Schools (CIS) International Accreditation Standards:** as a CIS member school, PEPS aligns its approach to global citizenship with CIS's four Drivers of accreditation — purpose & direction, learning & teaching, well-being for life, and the development of global citizenship — and in particular with Standards A3, C3 and D3, which require global citizenship to be purposefully defined, embedded in the written curriculum, and manifest in teaching and learning practice;
- **UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC) and Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR):** referenced by CIS as core statements of moral purpose underpinning global citizenship, safeguarding and child protection practice;
- **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs):** referenced in curriculum planning and student-led community projects, in line with the UAE's commitments as a signatory nation.

3 Our Definition of Global Citizenship

In line with CIS International Accreditation Standard A3, PEPS defines global citizenship in terms specific to our own school community, rather than relying on a generic definition:

At Providence English Private School, a global citizen is a member of our diverse, Sharjah-based community who takes pride in their own culture and in the UAE's tradition of tolerance and hospitality, while extending that same respect, curiosity and empathy to the many nationalities represented within our school. A PEPS global citizen thinks critically about local and global issues and how they are interconnected, and takes meaningful, age-appropriate action — through service, sustainability, and responsible civic and digital participation — to contribute positively to both the local Sharjah/UAE community and the wider world.

This definition is reviewed periodically by the Senior Leadership Team in consultation with staff, students and parents, and is intended to evolve as the school community reflects on what global citizenship means in its own context.

4 Scope & Applicability

This policy applies to all students at PEPS, from FS 2 to Year 13, and is reflected in:

- Classroom teaching and cross-curricular projects;
- Assemblies, national and international observance days, and cultural events;
- Community service, charitable and environmental initiatives;
- School trips and exchanges with a global or cultural learning focus;
- Student leadership opportunities, including student council and peer mentoring.

5 Roles & Responsibilities

Teachers

Teachers are responsible for embedding global citizenship themes into their subject teaching where appropriate, modelling respect for diversity, and supporting student-led initiatives related to community and global issues.

Staff Professional Development

Staff and leaders are supported through ongoing professional development to build their own intercultural competency and understanding of the diverse cultural contexts represented within the school community, in line with CIS expectations for staff and leadership practice.

Parents / Guardians

Parents/Guardians are encouraged to:

- Support their child's participation in cultural events, community service and global citizenship initiatives;
- Reinforce at home the values of respect, tolerance and social responsibility promoted by the school;
- Share their own cultural background and experiences, where willing, to enrich the school's diverse learning community.

Students

Students are expected to treat all members of the school community with respect regardless of nationality, culture, religion or background, to engage constructively with learning about global issues, and to take an active part in community service opportunities offered by the school.

The Senior Leadership Team

Ensures global citizenship is reflected in the school's calendar of events, curriculum planning and community partnerships, and that provision is evidenced and reviewed in line with CIS International Accreditation expectations.

6 Core Pillars of Global Citizenship at PEPS

6.1 National Identity & Heritage

The school fosters pride in and understanding of UAE culture, heritage, language and values, including through National Day, Flag Day, Commemoration Day and Martyrs' Day observances, and the integration of Arabic language, Islamic education and Social Studies curricula as mandated by the Ministry of Education.

6.2 Cultural Diversity & Tolerance

With a student body drawn from many nationalities, PEPS actively celebrates cultural diversity through

international days, cultural exhibitions, and cross-cultural learning projects. Discrimination of any kind — based on nationality, culture, religion, ethnicity or background — is not tolerated and will be addressed in line with the Behaviour & Discipline and Anti-Bullying Policies.

6.3 Inclusion, Diversity, Equity & Anti-Racism (I-DEA)

Beyond addressing discrimination when it occurs, PEPS takes a proactive approach to inclusion and equity: valuing the diverse characteristics and backgrounds of all students and staff, ensuring equity of opportunity across the school's many nationalities and language backgrounds, and building a culture of belonging in which students feel safe to explore issues of identity, difference and perspective. This includes ongoing staff and leadership development in intercultural competency, and regular review of school practices, materials and relationships through an I-DEA lens, in line with CIS International Accreditation standards.

6.4 Sustainability & Environmental Responsibility

Students are encouraged to understand their responsibility towards the environment, through curriculum links to the SDGs, sustainability-focused projects, and participation in relevant national environmental initiatives.

6.5 Community Service & Social Responsibility

The school promotes active citizenship through student-led charitable initiatives, community service hours, and partnerships with local charitable and humanitarian organisations, encouraging students to translate awareness into action.

6.6 Global Awareness & Critical Thinking

Students are supported to engage critically and empathetically with global issues — including poverty, human rights, conflict and migration — in an age-appropriate manner, developing the ability to consider multiple perspectives.

6.7 Student Voice & Leadership

Opportunities such as Student Council, Model United Nations-style activities (where offered), and peer mentoring give students a platform to develop leadership and advocate for causes they care about.

7 Implementation

Global citizenship is embedded not only in the written curriculum (Social Studies, Moral Education, Islamic Education) but also in cross-curricular teaching and learning practice, and in the informal and incidental curriculum — the everyday culture, relationships and climate of the school. Delivery is coordinated by the Senior Leadership Team in consultation with subject coordinators, and is periodically reviewed using CIS's Model and Continuum for Global Citizenship and Intercultural Learning as a reflective tool for continuous improvement.

8 Assessing Impact & Evidence

In line with CIS's expectation that schools evidence the impact of their global citizenship provision, PEPS gathers and reviews evidence including:

- Inclusion of global citizenship and intercultural learning in the written curriculum and schemes of work;
- Examples of student work, service-learning projects and cross-curricular initiatives;
- Participation rates in cultural, service and student leadership activities;
- Perception data gathered from students, staff and parents;
- Evidence of intercultural competency development among staff and leaders.

This evidence informs the annual review of this policy and the school's ongoing self-study for CIS International Accreditation.

9 Policy Links

- Behaviour & Discipline Policy
- Digital Citizenship Policy
- Anti-Bullying Policy
- Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy
- Wellbeing Policy
- Inclusion Policy

10 Monitoring & Evaluation

This policy will be reviewed annually by the Senior Leadership Team, in consultation with subject coordinators for Social Studies and Moral Education, or sooner if required by changes in national curriculum, SPEA guidance, or CIS International Accreditation standards.

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